

The Vault

A folder your company is written into, and an AI that reads it before answering you.

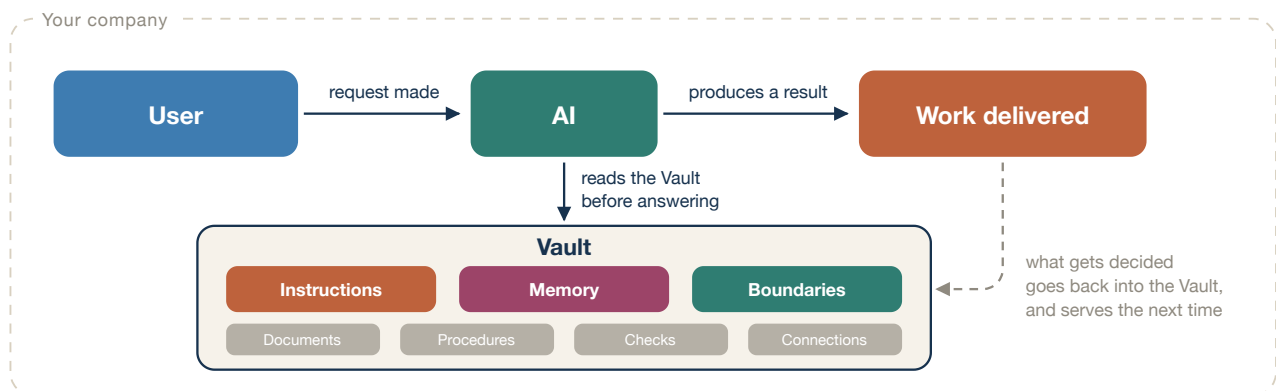
Everyone has tried getting an AI to write something. The result is correct, generic, and you have to explain it all again next time. **What is missing is not a better tool: it is that nobody ever told it how your company works.**

The Vault is that explanation, written down once and for all.

IN SHORT

- **Nothing to buy**, no software and no database.
- **On your own machine**, in a folder that belongs to you.
- **Readable by hand**, and correctable without us.
- What the field sometimes calls a « second brain », at company scale.

HOW A VAULT WORKS



The dotted arrow is the essential part, and it is the one nobody guesses: **what gets decided goes back into the Vault**, and serves the next time. It is the only reason the result improves over time instead of staying where it started.

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What is inside a Vault

Seven pieces, seven roles. None of them is software.

1 Text files, nothing else

What a Vault actually is

- A folder on your machine, with subfolders: clients, suppliers, projects, meetings, decisions, procedures.
- Every file is **plain text**. You open it, you read it, you correct it yourself, with nothing to install.
- File names are sentences: *why-we-changed-supplier, how-we-price-a-quote*.

There is no software underneath a Vault. If everything stopped tomorrow, your files would still be there and still readable.

2 The instructions

The file read before every answer

- Who you are, what the company does, how you want to be spoken to.
- What counts as a good answer here, and what is beside the point.

This is the file that changes everything, and it fits on one page.

3 The record of decisions

What was decided, and why

- Not just the choice: **the reason behind it**, with its date.
- Today that sits in two people's heads, and it leaves when they do.

4 The procedures

How you do things, written once

- How you price, how you follow up, how you deliver.
- Applied the same way every time, by anyone on the team.

5 The boundaries

What the AI is never allowed to do

- Written down in the Vault, not left to a judgement call.
- And what it must **stop and ask you about** before acting.

6 The automatic checks

What runs without being asked

- Controls set once, that run every time.
- They catch the lapse of attention, the one nobody notices.

7 The connections to your tools

Optional, and always last

- The link to your mail or your software, once the rest works.
- Never before: plugging into a shaky system only gets you to the wall faster.

None of these seven pieces is software. They are files, and that is what makes them yours.

How the Vault works over time

From day one to its first six months.

1 The loop Every piece of work feeds the next	• What was decided today is written into the Vault. • Tomorrow it is read again before you get an answer. Nobody had to do anything for that.
2 A question you could not ask before An example	« Why did we decide, back in March, not to go with that supplier? » • The answer is in the Vault, with its date and its reasoning. • Nobody explains the file again, and nobody redoes the analysis twice.
3 What a Vault becomes after six months The effect that matters	• The meetings, then the decisions, then the procedures, then what worked and what failed. • By then the Vault is worth <u>more than the tool that reads it</u>.
4 Your files first, tools second The difference from software	• Software holds your data: the day you leave it, you have to go and get it back. • Here the files stand on their own. Tools can be replaced without breaking anything. ----- Change tools tomorrow, the Vault is untouched.
5 How it starts The first few weeks	• We start from what already exists: your folders, your threads, your spreadsheets. • The instructions are written with you, in one session, not behind your back. • The rest fills up through real work. Nothing has to be entered up front.
6 Who writes in it You, the AI, or both	• The AI writes down what was decided, as the work happens. • You correct it when it is wrong. Nobody fills in forms, there is no data entry.
7 When the Vault is wrong What happens then	• Wrong information in the Vault gives a wrong answer, and it shows immediately. • You fix the file, not the conversation: <u>the mistake does not come back</u>.
8 What it asks of you The real time	• One session to write the instructions, with you, because nobody else knows how your company works. • After that, nothing beyond your usual work.
9 When several people use it Two, five, twenty	• The Vault is the same for everyone: they all work from one base, not from their own version. • What one person writes there serves the others without having to be passed on.

What it changes for you

A working week, before and after.

Today

You explain the context every single time. What was understood disappears when the window closes.

With a Vault

You ask. It already knows. What comes out looks like your company, not like a generic template.

What goes first

The time spent bringing someone back up to speed. It is the most expensive part of a working week, and the only one nobody counts.

What appears next

Answers that hold up without review, because they rest on what the company has already decided.

And the gap widens

Whoever writes down their decisions gains six months on whoever starts every conversation from scratch. That gap is not closed by buying a better tool.

And what does not change

The decisions stay yours, and so does the work. The Vault decides nothing.

The questions you have

The limits of a Vault, said before you find them.

1 « So it is magic, then? » No, and that matters	• A badly kept Vault is still a dumping ground, just a bigger one. • The value comes from the structure and the instructions, not from the number of files.
2 « What is the AI allowed to do? » The guardrails	• Nothing is sent and nothing is deleted without your say-so. • Sensitive actions are written down as forbidden, and the machine stops to ask.
3 « Where does my data go? » The question to ask before signing	• The Vault stays with you. What is shown to the AI, and what never is, is decided with you and written down. • A confidentiality agreement is signed before a single file is opened.
4 « What if the person using it leaves? » The serious objection	• The Vault stays, and it reads perfectly well without them. • It is the opposite of a dependency: <u>it is what removes one.</u>
5 « I already have a shared folder » The real difference	• A shared folder stores. A Vault is read and added to at every exchange. • And it holds two things no shared folder holds: why you decided, and what is off limits.
6 « How long before it helps? » The calendar question	• From the first week, for everything already written down somewhere. • The real difference shows after <u>two or three months</u>, when the record of decisions starts answering in your place.
7 « Could I do it myself? » Honestly, yes	• Nothing is secret: these are folders and text files, nobody holds a formula. • What takes time is knowing what to put in, in what order, and above all what to forbid.
8 « What if I change my mind in six months? » The way out	• You keep the files. They stay readable without us, and without any particular tool. • There is no subscription to cancel and no data to claw back.
9 « Will my teams have to learn a tool? » The adoption question	• No. Those who want nothing to change carry on: the files open normally. • Those who want to use it ask their questions in their own language, spoken or typed.
10 « Does it work in my language? » The multilingual question	• The Vault is written in your company's language, whichever that is. • And files in one language answer questions asked in another: <u>a quote received in English can be summarised in yours</u>, with no translation step.

A short glossary, to understand the Vault

Six terms, explained simply.

Vault

The English word for a strongroom. In this trade it means a folder of files in which someone has written down how a company works, so an AI can read it before doing anything. No software hides behind the word: open that folder on your computer and you will find subfolders and text files, like in any working folder.

Markdown, or « .md » files

A way of writing text where headings, lists and emphasis are marked with two or three simple signs, inside the sentence itself. It is neither software nor a subscription. The point is twofold. **An AI reads this text directly**, whereas a Word document has to be unzipped and converted first, one more step that sometimes loses what it carries. And the file stays plain text, so any computer will still open it in thirty years, without the program that created it.

VS Code

The workspace where the AI works on your files, and where you talk to it. The window has two parts: your folders on the left, and on the right a conversation panel where you write what you want, in whichever language suits you. The AI reads the files concerned, answers you, and changes only what you allow it to change, in front of you. It is a developer's tool originally, but **you do not write any code**: you talk.

Second brain

The nickname the field gives to a Vault. It comes from personal use, where people file their reading and their ideas. Same object, different purpose: here it is not your own memory, it is your company's, and it serves several people.

Obsidian

A free program used to read the Vault comfortably: your folders on one side, the open file on the other, and the ability to jump between files by following references. It stores nothing and changes nothing, it displays. Install it, use it for six months, uninstall it: the Vault does not move.

Context

Everything the AI knows about your company before you have asked a single question: your trade, your clients, your rules, what has already been decided. It is why the same question gets a bland answer from one person and a sharp one from another. The quality of an answer depends far more on this than on how you phrase the request, and it is exactly what a Vault provides.